33. For Tagore's invocation of Ashoka, see Sen (1997): 9.

34. Ananya Vajpeyi argues that Nehru may well have seen himself as 'the new Asoka'. For this and various elements which made Ashoka a major figure in Nehru's quest as a political leader, Vajpeyi (2012): 194–200.

35. For the text of the resolution moved by Nehru, see Agrawala (1964).

36. Allen (2012); Kejariwal (1988): 202–9; Chakrabarti (1988): 33–4.

37. This has been discussed at length in the epilogue of the present book.

38. Cunningham (1877).

39. By the time Hultzsch's *Corpus Inscriptionum Indicarum* was published in 1925, several minor rock edicts in Karnataka had been discovered and their texts were, thus, included in it. For a chronology of the discoveries of the edicts and inscriptions, see the appendix of the present book.

40. Indraji was also the discoverer of some of the Sopara edicts. Virchand Dharamsey's book (2012) is essential reading for an understanding of the remarkable life of this pioneering archaeologist.

41. Ibid.: 139.

42. See the appendix of the present book.

43. See Thaplyal (2009).

44. Smith (1909).

45. Ibid.: 23.

46. He is known to have said that 'the best elements in the plastic, pictorial, numismatic and dramatic arts of ancient India are of foreign, chiefly Graeco-Roman origin.' Smith (1889).

47. Smith (1909): 46, 47.

48. Bhandarkar (1925): vii.

49. Ibid.: 61.

50. Mookerji (1928).

51. Barua (1946): 329–30.

52. Thapar (1961).

53. Ibid.: 138–40.

54. Ibid.: 5.

55. Ibid.: 214–15.